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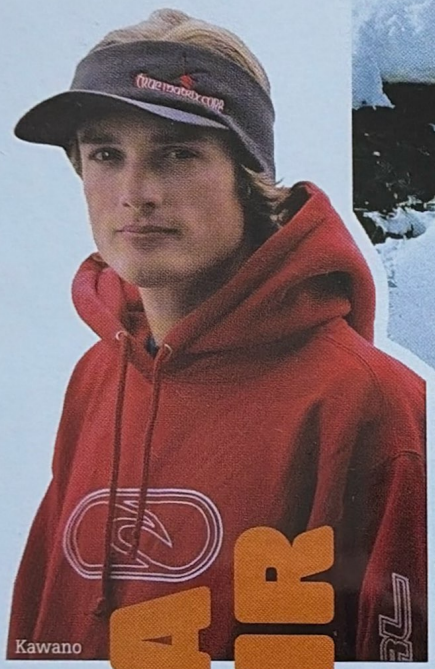

Kawano

DANA FLAHR

Location: Coast Mountains, British Columbia. Photo: Bryn Hughes

Age: 22
Hometown: Kamloops, British Columbia
Residing: Whistler, British Columbia
Sponsors: Dynastar, Rip Curl, Oakley, Jib Culture, BASE Energy Drink, Momentum Ski Camps

You've earned yourself a reputation as being competent in both the park and big-mountain arenas. Which do you prefer?

I feel most comfortable skiing big mountain. I did the IFSA world tour this year and placed in the top fifteen. I got a sixth at the U.S. Nationals in Snowbird and came in first overall on the North American IFSA tour. I do a little bit of local slopestyle stuff, but over the past couple years it hasn't really been my focus. I like the big-mountain comps because they push me to be as good a skier as humanly possible. After every contest I feel like I learn something and become better for it.

Aside from competing, do you go out-of-bounds often?

I've had a sled for two seasons now. I sucked at first, but I got a lot better from following [Dan] Treadway around because he's so good on his.

Having Treadway as your mentor can be hazardous. What specifically has he taught you about snowmobiles?

I've realized you can't be afraid to pin it.

Have you been involved in any sketchy incidents?

One day, first thing in the morning, I was trying to cross a creek, and I hit the uphill side of it and fell back off my sled into the creek. I was standing in knee-deep water for about five minutes before anyone came back to lift me out. The sled was teetering and almost fell on me. Treadway was just laughing.

You've been trying to incorporate some park tricks into your big-mountain runs. Have you stomped anything you're particularly proud of?

My most stoked moment was at the U.S. Nationals in Snowbird last season. It got sunny, and there was this big 50-foot cliff at the bottom. There was crazy pow, so I scoped out the landing and threw a misty 7 off it in the comp.

Did Treadway persuade you to do it?

It was actually Moss Patterson. He and I see eye to eye with how we want to ski and how we'd like to see these competitions progress. He blew out his knee the day before and was like, "Dana, see that cliff there? I was planning on throwing a misty 7 off it. I won't be able to now, so I want you to do it." I thought it was a great idea, so I went ahead and, you know, gave 'er

—Jeff Foss